

# Jacob Hazen

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## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. in Economics** 2022 – Expected April 2027

*McGill University*

Advisors: Prof. Fabian Lange and Prof. Fernando Saltiel

**M.A. in Economics, Specialization in Data Science (Thesis)** 2020 – 2022

*Carleton University*

Advisor: Prof. Ba Chu

**B.A. in Economics, Minor in Computer Science** 2016 – 2020

*University of Calgary*

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## RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

**Primary:** Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

**Secondary:** Applied Econometrics, Economics of Education

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## JOB MARKET PAPER

**“It’s More Than Time and Money: How the Parent-Child Relationship Shapes Skill Formation”**

*Abstract:* I study how the parent-child relationship shapes the development of children’s socio-emotional skills. I develop and estimate a dynamic model of household decision-making in which parents allocate time across work, leisure, and active time with the child, and choose how much to spend on the child. These choices build a parent-child bond, which captures emotional warmth and consistency. Investment affects skills mainly through the bond: it builds the bond, which in turn builds skills, while its direct effect on skills is small. I also find that mothers’ active time is the most productive input into investment, followed by fathers’ active time and then expenditures on the child. Counterfactual analysis shows that policies raising family income have little effect on parental investment, although they raise the bond more than they raise skills. Policies that could change how parents value the child’s skills or the relationship, or that directly strengthen the bond, such as school-based or family therapy programs, are more effective at raising socio-emotional skills. These findings place the parent-child bond, rather than investment itself, at the centre of the technology of socio-emotional skill formation.

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## WORKS IN PROGRESS

**“Human Capital Development of Socio-Emotional Skills in Children”**

*Best Third-Year Research Paper Award; CRDCN Award & Webinar; SSHRC Doctoral Award*

**“Persistent Inequality in Maternal Mental Health”**

*With Fernando Saltiel*

**“Parenting Style and Multidimensional Skills”**

*With Kentaro Asai*

## REPORTS

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**“Did the Pandemic and Current Labour Shortages Change the Quality of Jobs?”** 2024

*With Mahmut Ablay, Luc Bissonnette, and Fabian Lange*

Funded under the Government of Canada’s Future Skills program

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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**Teaching Assistant** McGill University & Carleton University

*Graduate:* Graduate Economic Data Science, Graduate Macroeconomics

*Undergraduate:* Applied Data Analysis, Introductory Econometrics, Introductory Microeconomics, Introductory Macroeconomics, Economic Statistics, Game Theory

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Research Assistant** 2023

*McGill University*

For Prof. Fabian Lange

**Research Assistant** 2022

*Queen’s & Carleton University*

For Prof. James MacKinnon, Prof. Matt Webb, Prof. Morten Ørregaard Nielsen

**Research Assistant (Computer Science)** 2022

*Carleton University*

APEX Group

**Research Assistant** 2020

*University of Calgary (PatiML)*

For Prof. Alexander Whalley

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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**Junior Data Science Analyst** 2021–2022

*Infrastructure Canada*

**Data Analyst, Data Science (Internship)** 2021

*Infrastructure Canada*

**Data Scientist (Internship)** 2020

*Critical Mass*

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

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*Conference & Seminar Presentations*

Royal Economic Society Conference (2026); Canadian Economics Association 60th Annual Conference (2026); 20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students’ Conference (2026); CRDCN Emerging Scholars Webinar (2025); Canadian Economics Association 59th Annual Conference (2025); “Artificial Intelligence in Economics,” Expanding Economics & McGill AI Society (2024)

### *Service*

President, McGill Economics Graduate Society (2024–present); Ph.D. Representative, CIREQ (2024–present); Co-President, Carleton Graduate Economics Society (2021–2022)

### **HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND FELLOWSHIPS**

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>CRDCN Emerging Scholar Award (\$1,200)</b>                                  | 2025 |
| <b>Best Third-Year Research Paper Award, McGill University</b>                 | 2025 |
| <b>SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship (\$80,000)</b>                                    | 2025 |
| <b>Graduate Excellence Award in Economics (5-year Ph.D. funding)</b>           | 2022 |
| <b>Ontario Graduate Scholarship (Declined, \$15,000)</b>                       | 2022 |
| <b>Randall Geehan Memorial Scholarship in Quantitative Economics (\$1,200)</b> | 2022 |
| <b>Departmental Merit Scholarship, Carleton University</b>                     | 2020 |
| <b>Dean's List, University of Calgary</b>                                      | 2020 |
| <b>University of Calgary Faculty of Science IDEAS Fund Award</b>               | 2020 |
| <b>Jason Lang Scholarship, University of Calgary</b>                           | 2019 |
| <b>Alexander Rutherford Scholarship, Government of Alberta</b>                 | 2016 |

### **REFERENCES**

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#### *Placement Directors*

##### **Prof. Rui Castro**

Department of Economics, McGill University  
Leacock 519, 855 Sherbrooke St W  
Montreal, QC H3A 2T7  
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##### **Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto**

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855 Sherbrooke St W  
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#### *Reference Letters*

##### **Prof. Fabian Lange**

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Montreal, QC H3A 2T7  
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##### **Prof. Fernando Saltiel**

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##### **Prof. Nicolas Gendron-Carrier**

Department of Economics, McGill University  
Leacock 321C, 855 Sherbrooke St W  
Montreal, QC H3A 2T7  
nicolas.gendron-carrier@mcgill.ca

### **PROGRAMMING SKILLS**

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Python, R, Stata, SQL, Bash/Unix/Linux, Git, Matlab, Julia; Docker, PostGIS/RDBMS, LaTeX

### **LANGUAGES**

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English (Native), French (Intermediate)